Understanding a Multi-Company SaaS Accounting Platform

A simple explanation of the 5 (really 6) user roles — for Diplav's SaaS finance platform (MARKGO), inspired by AccountGo SaaS by WorkDo.

The Big Picture: Amazon Business + Tally, Rented Out to Many Companies

Imagine you build one piece of software, and instead of one company using it, you **rent** it out to hundreds of different companies — a bakery, a furniture shop, a clothing store, and so on. Each company only sees **its own** data; they never see each other's. This is called "multi-tenant" software.

Inside **each company's account**, there are people with different jobs. The example used throughout this document is one company: **"Ramesh Furniture Pvt Ltd"**.

1. Super Admin — the platform owner (you)

Not part of any company. This is you, running the SaaS platform itself as a business.

- Creates subscription plans (Free, ■999/month, ■2999/month)
- Sees every company that signed up on the platform
- Can suspend or activate any company if they don't pay
- Does not touch anyone's actual accounting data — only manages the SaaS business

Real-world parallel: the person who owns Shopify. They don't run your store; they run the platform your store sits on.

2. Company Admin — the owner of Ramesh Furniture

This is Ramesh himself, who signed up for the SaaS platform.

- Creates his own company account on the platform
- Invites his own staff (accountant, salespeople) into his company
- Adds his own customers and vendors
- Sees all of Ramesh Furniture's data: sales, purchases, profit & loss, everyone's activity
- Sets permissions, e.g. “my accountant can create invoices but can't delete them”

He's the boss inside his own tenant, but invisible to other companies on the platform, and can't touch the Super Admin's plan/pricing controls.

3. Accountant — Ramesh's bookkeeper

An employee Ramesh hires or invites specifically for money matters.

- Manages the finance side: creates invoices/bills, records payments received and paid
- Does bank reconciliation (matches what the bank says vs. what the books say)
- Generates reports: Profit & Loss, Balance Sheet, Trial Balance, tax reports
- Usually cannot manage products or add/remove staff — just money

Real-world parallel: the person doing Ramesh's Tally / QuickBooks entries every evening.

4. Staff — the shop floor / sales employee

A regular employee, more operational than financial.

- Adds new products to the catalog (e.g. “Wooden Dining Table – ■15,000”)
- Creates a sale when a customer buys something, or records a purchase when new stock arrives
- Mostly day-to-day data entry, with restricted permissions (can't see full financial reports or manage subscriptions)

Real-world parallel: the salesperson who makes the bill when you buy furniture in the shop.

5. Vendor — Ramesh's supplier

Someone Ramesh buys from — e.g. a timber wholesaler or hardware supplier.

- Has a limited login into Ramesh's company account (not the whole platform)
- Can see the purchase orders Ramesh placed with them
- Can see bills raised to them and whether they've been paid
- Cannot see Ramesh's sales to customers, other vendors, or his profit numbers — only their own transactions with him

Real-world parallel: a “vendor portal” — the timber supplier logs in just to check “has Ramesh paid my last invoice yet?”

6. Customer — the person buying furniture from Ramesh

Someone who buys from Ramesh Furniture.

- Gets a limited login to see their own invoices
- Can view or download the invoice for what they bought
- Can pay online (Stripe / Razorpay) and see their payment history
- Cannot see Ramesh's other customers, vendors, or internal finances — only their own bill

Real-world parallel: logging into Amazon and seeing only your own order history and invoices — never anyone else's.

What “Manage Finance” Means for Each Role

The 5 tenant-level roles are just different views and permissions over the same sell → buy → record → report cycle. Vendor and Customer are the two *external* parties (money in, money out); Company Admin, Accountant and Staff are the *internal* team running the books.

Role	What they add to the finance picture
Company Admin	Sees the full P&L — total money in vs. out
Accountant	Records every transaction, reconciles bank, produces reports
Staff	Creates the sale/purchase entries that become the transactions
Vendor	Triggers “money going out” (Ramesh owes them for stock bought)

Role	What they add to the finance picture
Customer	Triggers “money coming in” (they owe Ramesh for goods bought)
Super Admin	Collects Ramesh's subscription fee — a separate revenue stream, not part of Ramesh's books

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Notes for the MARKGO build: role hierarchy — SUPER_ADMIN, COMPANY_ADMIN, ACCOUNTANT, STAFF, VENDOR, CUSTOMER — maps directly onto the roles above, with Company scoping on every table so one company can never query another company's records.